



English — Cbse English — Combined Half-Yearly (40 Marks)

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The paper has four sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Section D assesses the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 1 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> India's Rainfall by the Numbers India's economy and ecology are deeply tied to the monsoon, which delivers roughly 75 percent of the country's annual rainfall between June and September. According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), the Long Period Average (LPA) of the southwest monsoon, based on data from 1971 to 2020, stands at 88 centimetres. Any figure between 96 and 104 percent of this benchmark is classified as "normal." The monsoon, however, is anything but uniform. In 2019, the country recorded 110 percent of the LPA, making it the wettest season in a quarter century. By contrast, the 2023 monsoon settled at 94 percent of the LPA, officially categorised as below normal. Such year-to-year swings directly affect reservoir levels, irrigation, and crop sowing. Regional disparities are equally striking. Mawsynram in Meghalaya, often called the wettest place on Earth, receives an annual average of about 11,871 millimetres, while parts of western Rajasthan struggle with less than 200 millimetres. This vast gap shapes everything from cropping patterns to drinking-water security. Climate scientists warn that rising global temperatures are intensifying these extremes. A 2020 report by the Ministry of Earth Sciences noted that extreme rainfall events over central India have risen sharply since 1950, even as the total number of rainy days has declined. In other words, it is raining less often but harder when it does. Sustainable water management — rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, and efficient irrigation — is therefore no longer optional. With over half of India's cultivated land still rain-fed, every millimetre of monsoon rainfall carries an economic weight that the nation can ill afford to waste. (i) According to the passage, what share of India's annual rainfall does the southwest monsoon deliver? [2 mark(s)] (A) 75 percent (B) 88 percent (C) 94 percent (D) 110 percent Ans: A <i>The first paragraph explicitly states that the monsoon delivers roughly 75 percent of the country's annual rainfall between June and September.</i> (ii) What can be inferred from the passage about the trend in rainfall patterns over central India since 1950? [2 mark(s)] (A) Rainy days have increased while the intensity of each event has decreased. (B) Both the number of rainy days and the intensity of downpours have risen equally. (C) Fewer rainy days now bring heavier downpours than they did in the past. (D) The total number of rainy days has remained unchanged despite rising temperatures.	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Ans: C <i>The passage notes that extreme rainfall events have risen sharply since 1950 even as the total number of rainy days has declined, implying that rain is falling less frequently but with greater intensity.</i> (iii) The word "striking" in the sentence "Regional disparities are equally striking" most nearly means: [2 mark(s)] (A) harmful (B) remarkable (C) unexpected (D) minor Ans: B <i>In context, "striking" is used to emphasise how noticeable and remarkable the regional differences in rainfall are, making "remarkable" the closest synonym.</i> (iv) Why does the passage describe sustainable water management as "no longer optional" rather than merely "important"? [2 mark(s)] Ans: Because over half of India's cultivated land is still rain-fed and climate change is intensifying rainfall extremes, making efficient water management a necessity, not a choice. <i>The final paragraph links India's heavy dependence on rain-fed agriculture and the growing intensity of rainfall extremes to argue that water management has become essential for economic survival, not just desirable.</i> (v) What is the central concern of the passage regarding India's monsoon? [2 mark(s)] Ans: The passage highlights the growing unpredictability and regional unevenness of India's monsoon rainfall and stresses the urgent need for sustainable water management to cope with these changes. <i>Across all five paragraphs, the passage tracks year-to-year and region-to-region variation in monsoon rainfall and concludes that these shifts demand sustainable water-management practices.</i>	
Section B — Writing Attempt 1 out of 1.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	Informal Letter You are Vivaan/Vanya, a Class 9 student living at 18, Saffron Street, Pune. Your grandparents, who live in Nagpur, sent you a Kindle e-reader as a birthday gift. Write a letter to them thanking them for the gift and sharing some exciting news about a recent achievement at school. In your letter you may touch upon: • how much you love the gift and how you are using it • the exciting news you want to share (e.g., a competition result) • your plans to visit them during the holidays Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 18, Saffron Street Pune 10 March 2025 Dear Dada and Dadi, I hope you both are keeping well. I am writing to thank you from the bottom of my heart for the wonderful Kindle you sent me for my birthday. It was such a thoughtful gift! I have already downloaded several books and am enjoying reading before bedtime every night. I also wanted to share some exciting news with you. Last week, I participated in our school's inter-house science exhibition and my project on solar energy won the first prize! My science teacher praised my effort and even recommended me for the district-level competition next month. I am working hard to prepare for it. Please take good care of your health. I miss you both very much and look forward to visiting you during the summer holidays. Give my love to everyone at home. With love, Vanya • Thank grandparents sincerely for the Kindle e-reader sent as a birthday gift • Mention how the gift is being used (e.g., downloading and reading books) • Share exciting news about winning a school science exhibition • Express love and anticipation of visiting them during the summer holidays • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s) OR Paragraph	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Write a paragraph in 90–130 words on My Favourite Festival. You may use the following cues: • Name the festival and mention when it is usually celebrated. • Describe how you and your family celebrate it. • Explain why it is your favourite and what feeling or memory it brings to you. (Word limit: 90–130 words; Suggested time: 20 min) Model Answer: Diwali, the festival of lights, is my favourite festival, celebrated every year in October or November. Our family begins preparations days in advance by cleaning and decorating our home with colourful rangoli and earthen lamps. On Diwali night, we perform a small puja, share homemade sweets with neighbours, and light diyas on every windowsill. What I love most is the warmth and togetherness it brings — cousins gather, laughter fills the rooms, and the sky glows with lanterns. This year, we chose green crackers and reusable decorations, which made the celebration more meaningful. Diwali reminds me that light always triumphs over darkness, and that joy grows when shared with the people we love. • Names the festival (Diwali) and states when it is celebrated (October/November). • Describes family celebration traditions — rangoli, diyas, puja, sharing sweets. • Explains why it is the favourite — warmth, togetherness, and joy of sharing. • Includes a positive, eco-friendly action — green crackers and reusable decorations. • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	
Section C — Grammar Attempt all 5 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
3	Identify the incorrectly used word: 'The stationery vehicle [Vocabulary — Homophones] (A) remained (B) motionless (C) traffic (D) stationery Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? The word 'stationery' refers to writing materials such as paper, pens, and envelopes. The sentence describes a vehicle that is not moving, which requires 'stationary' (meaning not in motion). This is a homophone error: 'stationery' (writing materials) has been used where 'stationary' (not moving) is required. The words 'remained', 'motionless', and 'traffic' are all used correctly in the sentence.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	The principal addressed the assembly ___ the entire teaching staff, expressing gratitude for their dedication throughout the academic year. [Prepositions] (A) in front of (B) in spite of (C) on account of (D) on behalf of Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? 'On behalf of' means representing or in the name of someone, which fits the context of the principal speaking as a representative of the teaching staff. 'In front of' indicates physical position, 'in spite of' expresses contrast, and 'on account of' gives a reason — none of which match the meaning of representing a group.	1
5	The government has launched a nationwide campaign to promote digital literacy among schoolchildren. Identify the type of the sentence given above. [Sentences — Types] (A) Assertive (B) Interrogative (C) Imperative (D) Exclamatory Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? The sentence states a fact about a government initiative, has an explicitly stated subject ('The government'), and ends with a full stop. These are the defining features of an assertive (declarative) sentence. An interrogative sentence would ask a question and end with a question mark, an imperative sentence would give a command with an implied subject, and an exclamatory sentence would express strong emotion and end with an exclamation mark.	1
6	___ attempts were made to rescue the trapped miners before the operation finally succeeded. [Adjectives (Describing Words)] (A) Numerous (B) Much (C) Little (D) Enough Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? The noun 'attempts' is countable and plural, so the adjective must answer 'How many?' and agree with a plural countable noun. 'Numerous' is an adjective of number meaning 'many' and correctly modifies 'attempts'. 'Much' and 'Little' are adjectives of quantity used with uncountable nouns, and 'Enough' in this context does not convey the sense of repeated, multiple efforts that the sentence requires.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
7	How swiftly the river flows! [Sentence Transformation] (A) The river flows swiftly. (B) The river is flowing swiftly. (C) The river flows very swiftly. (D) The river flowed very swiftly. Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? When converting an exclamatory sentence beginning with 'How' to assertive form, the exclamatory word is removed and 'very' is added before the adverb or adjective to preserve the intensity. 'How swiftly the river flows!' becomes 'The river flows very swiftly.' Options A and B lose the intensifier 'very', and option D incorrectly changes the tense from present to past.	1
Section D — Literature Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
8	Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect. (i) I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine. (ii) I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life. Answer: The given pair of statements displays a cause-effect relationship. Statement (i) states, "I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine." This medical diagnosis serves as the cause or the initiating event. Statement (ii) states, "I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life." This represents the effect or the outcome of the previous event. Because the diagnosis directly led to the surgery and its resulting prognosis, the second statement is a direct consequence of the first. Furthermore, both statements are factual events rather than personal beliefs, eliminating the possibility of a fact-opinion relationship. ► Why? The statements display a cause-effect relationship because the diagnosis of a spinal tumour (statement i) is the cause that directly led to the surgery and the prognosis of being bound to a wheelchair (statement ii). Both statements are factual, so it is not a fact-opinion pair. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Analyze statement (i) as the initiating event (cause). - Step 2: Analyze statement (ii) as the resulting outcome (effect). - Step 3: Conclude that since one event directly led to the other, it is a cause-effect relationship. [Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]	2
9	What are the means for people to stay connected?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Historically, people stayed connected through telegrams, which were used for fast, short, and specific messages like greetings and condolences. Another traditional means was the postal system, where mail was dropped in a post box and delivered by a postman or Gramin Dak Sewaks who served as the sole link in extreme areas. In present times, the internet allows us to be just a click away from sending mail. Additionally, phone lines and cell phones, particularly through networks like BSNL, help people in remote areas connect to the world. Gramin Sanchar Sewaks also carry cell phones and post to ensure connectivity. ► <i>Why?</i> The textbook context provides several means of connection across different times. In the past, telegrams and the postal system (including postmen and Gramin Dak Sewaks) were the primary modes. In the present, the internet, phone lines, and cell phones (like BSNL) serve as the means to stay connected, with some workers acting as Gramin Sanchar Sewaks carrying both post and cell phones. [Ch 13: Carrier of Words]	
10	Which words are repeated in the poem? Why does the poet use repetition? Answer: The words "words", "satisfy", and "heart" are repeatedly used in the poem. The poet constantly refers to "words" as the central subject, while "satisfy" and "heart" are used to show what words fail to achieve. The poet uses this repetition to emphasize the contrasting ideas associated with words. By repeating "satisfy", the poet highlights the stark contrast between the expectation that words can comfort the heart and the harsh reality that they often "satisfy the least". This repetition reinforces the theme of the superficial nature of words, showing that they ultimately leave only "empty air". ► <i>Why?</i> The context shows the poet repeatedly using 'words', 'satisfy', and 'heart' to build the poem's central argument. The repetition of 'satisfy' specifically contrasts the hypothetical ability of words to fulfill the heart ('If words could satisfy') with their actual failure ('Oft satisfy the least'). This emphasizes the superficiality and inadequacy of mere words in providing real comfort, leaving behind only 'empty air'. [Ch 14: Words]	2
11	What does the electrician 'humming' while getting ready for work suggest? Answer: The electrician 'humming' while getting ready for work suggests their joy and pride in their vocation. In the poem, all vocations are seen as a form of celebration, and humming indicates that the electrician is happy and content with their work. It also reflects the idea that the voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity. The humming shows their dedication and readiness to work with cables and wires to brighten our lives. It symbolises that they do not see their work as a burden, but rather as a joyful contribution to the nation's celebration.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The question asks for an interpretation of the electrician humming. The context states that the electricians are 'humming' as they 'get ready for work, work with cables and wires to brighten our lives'. The broader context of the poem emphasizes that vocations are a 'celebration' and that 'the voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity'. Therefore, humming signifies happiness, pride, and a celebratory approach to their identity and work. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	
12	Why does the poet compare music to a 'needed friend'? Answer: The poet compares music to a needed friend because it offers unwavering support and comfort during difficult times. When she feels sad or blue, music acts as therapy that eases her pain and lifts her spirits, ensuring she can pull through her struggles. Furthermore, just like a true friend who stands by you when others abandon you, music is always present when no one seems to care. It is a dependable companion that provides emotional strength and solace, making it an essential and much-needed presence in the poet's life. ► Why? The question asks for the reason behind the metaphor of music as a 'needed friend'. The poem explicitly states music is the needed friend 'When no one seems to care'. Additionally, the context from the poem and the diary entry highlights music's role as 'therapy' when she feels 'blue', lifting her 'spirits' to help her 'pull through', and being a 'dependable' companion. The answer synthesizes these points to explain the comparison fully. [Ch 12: A Friend Found in Music]	2
13	What is the purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky? Answer: The purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky is to show that the mother's presence is vast, comforting, and protective. Just as the sky stretches endlessly and watches over the earth, the mother's love and watchful gaze surround the poet entirely. Furthermore, the sky acts as a symbolic extension of the mother's presence. Even though the poet cannot physically remember her, looking into the distant blue sky allows him to feel her stillness and warmth. This comparison beautifully connects nature with his deep emotional bond, making her presence felt universally and eternally through the calmness of the sky. ► Why? The context provides an MCQ option indicating that the sky is a 'symbolic extension of the mother's presence'. The poem's third stanza mentions the 'stillness of my mother's gaze' spreading 'all over the sky'. This comparison highlights the vast, protective, and eternal nature of a mother's love, using nature to evoke the feeling of her presence even in her physical absence. [Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]	2
14	Which language(s) do your grandparents or elderly relatives speak?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: My elderly relatives, specifically my grandmother (Avva), speak Kannada. She speaks the specific Kannada dialect that is native to the north Karnataka region. This is her primary language of communication and comfort in her daily life. Furthermore, her deep connection to this language is evident through her strong desire to learn the Kannada alphabet at the age of sixty-two. Since she could not read, she depended on others to read Kannada stories and magazines to her, proving that Kannada is the only language she speaks and wishes to read. ► Why? The question is a reflective prompt from the chapter 'How I Taught My Grandmother to Read'. Using the provided context, the answer focuses on the grandmother (Avva) as the elderly relative. The text explicitly mentions 'the Kannada spoken in north Karnataka' and her desire to learn the 'Kannada alphabet', establishing Kannada as her spoken and desired literary language. [Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]	
15	The poet uses imagery (descriptive language to create vivid mental pictures that appeal to the senses). Give any two examples from the poem. Answer: The poet uses imagery to create vivid mental pictures that appeal to the senses. The first example is "sunny golden land", which creates a bright, radiant visual picture of the country, appealing to the sense of sight and suggesting its richness and glory. A second example is the depiction of the Ganga, which is described as generous and graceful. This creates a vivid visual image of the flowing river, appealing to the senses and symbolising purity and generosity. ► Why? The question asks for two examples of imagery (descriptive language appealing to the senses). Based on the context, 'sunny golden land' is a visual description suggesting richness and glory. The 'Ganga' is depicted as generous and graceful, creating a visual image of the river's purity. The 'Himavant' described as mighty and unparalleled is also a valid example of visual imagery suggesting strength. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	2
16	The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem. Answer: Two examples of adjective-noun collocations from the poem are gold medals and beaming faces. In the phrase gold medals, the word 'gold' acts as an adjective modifying the noun 'medals', indicating the type or colour of the medals. Similarly, in beaming faces, the present participle 'beaming' functions as an adjective describing the noun 'faces', showing the athletes' joy. Other valid examples from the poem include young boy and Special Olympics. In young boy, the adjective 'young' describes the noun 'boy', and in Special Olympics, the adjective 'Special' modifies the proper noun 'Olympics'.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? An adjective-noun collocation is a pair of words where an adjective habitually modifies a noun. In the poem's final stanza, 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces' perfectly fit this criterion, as 'gold' describes the medals and 'beaming' describes the faces. Other acceptable pairs from the provided text include 'young boy' and 'Special Olympics'. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Understand that an adjective-noun collocation consists of an adjective modifying a noun that habitually appears together. 2. Step 2: Scan the poem lines provided in the context for adjective-noun pairs (e.g., in the line 'with nine gold medals' and 'nine beaming faces'). 3. Step 3: Identify two clear examples, such as 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces', and explain how the adjective modifies the noun in each pair. [Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]	
17	Do you think Shruti will gather the courage to speak to her father? Give a reason. Answer: Yes, Shruti will gather the courage to speak to her father. Despite being worried about his strict views on classical music, she receives encouragement from her friends, Iqbal and Peter, which boosts her confidence. She promises them, "Tonight, at dinner, I promise to bring this up." Furthermore, the text confirms that she finally gathers the courage to inform her father about the concert. During dinner, though initially hesitant, she directly speaks to him, saying she was finding the right words to tell him something. This shows her determination to overcome her fear and communicate her wishes. ► Why? The question asks if Shruti will gather courage, and the provided context clearly shows she does. In Act I, her friends encourage her, and she resolves to speak to her father at dinner. By Act II, she overcomes her hesitation and initiates the difficult conversation with him during dinner, proving she gathered the necessary courage. [Ch 11: Twin Melodies]	2

